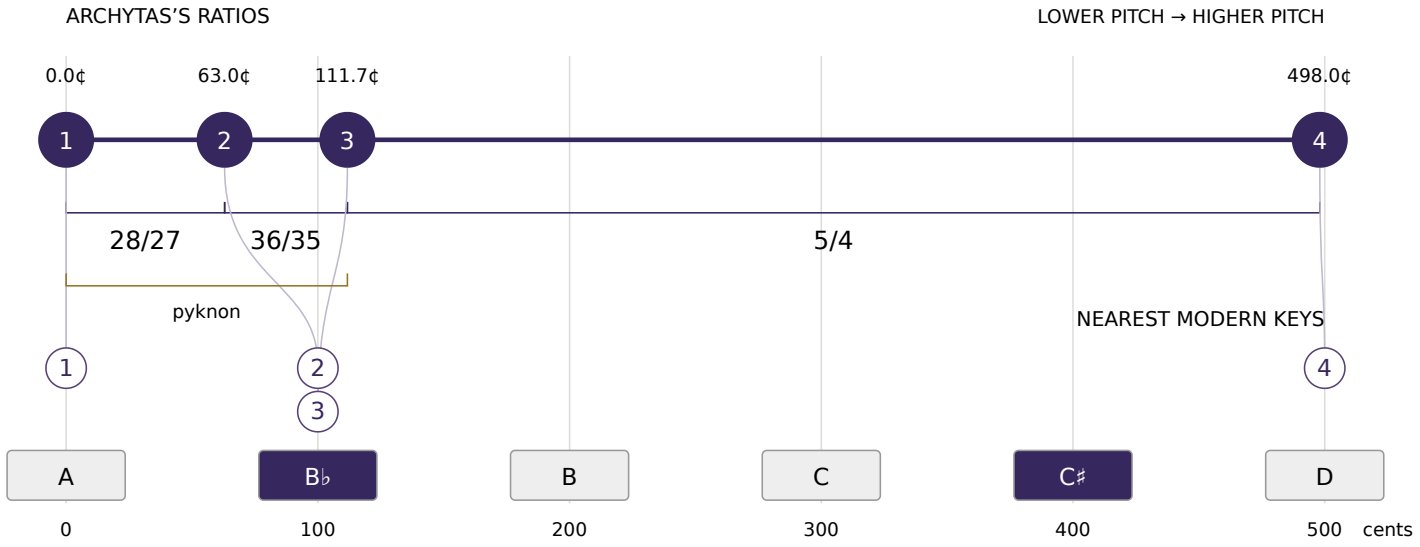
Enharmonic ἐναρμόνιον

Archytas’s division, as reported by Ptolemy. Modern reference: A3 = 220 Hz. Playback direction: ascending.



Adjacent ascending ratios: 28/27 (62.96 cents) → 36/35 (48.77 cents) → 5/4 (386.31 cents). Together: 4/3, or 498.04 cents.

Ancient ratios and modern nearest-100-cent comparison

Note	Ratio to base	Hz	Cents	Rounded Hz	Shift (¢)
1	1/1	220.000	0.00	220.000	0.00
2	28/27	228.148	62.96	233.082	37.04
3	16/15	234.667	111.73	233.082	-11.73
4	4/3	293.333	498.04	293.665	1.96

The two inner notes round to the same modern key. The rounded sequence has only three distinct pitches. Rounding is a modern comparison, not an ancient tuning.

Source: Ptolemy, Harmonics I.13, Greek and Latin edition by John Wallis (Oxford, 1682), pp. 62–63. This study models transmitted ratios. A chosen modern pitch reference and synthesized sine tones do not reconstruct an ancient performance. ‘One moving note’ describes this particular scheme, not every ancient tetrachord.

Open this listening study · Source code. This document contains its own diagram and styles and makes no external requests.